¿DÓNDE ESTÁ?
WHERE THINGS ARE

grey is the thing you are talking about — orange is what you are placing

1. Twelve pictures, in pairs the opposite is drawn alongside, because the contrast is the meaning



encima de · sobre / debajo de
on top of · over / under



dentro de / fuera de
inside / outside



delante de / detrás de
in front of / behind



cerca de / lejos de
near / far from



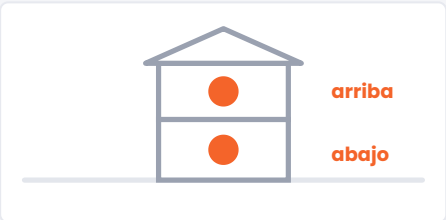
a la izquierda / a la derecha
to the left / to the right of



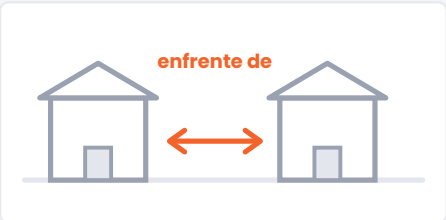
al lado de = junto a
beside — junto a is tighter



entre / alrededor de
between / around



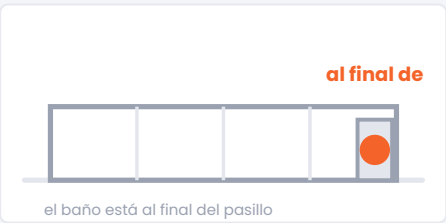
arriba / abajo
upstairs / downstairs — no *de*



enfrente de
opposite, facing



en
the catch-all — on *or* in

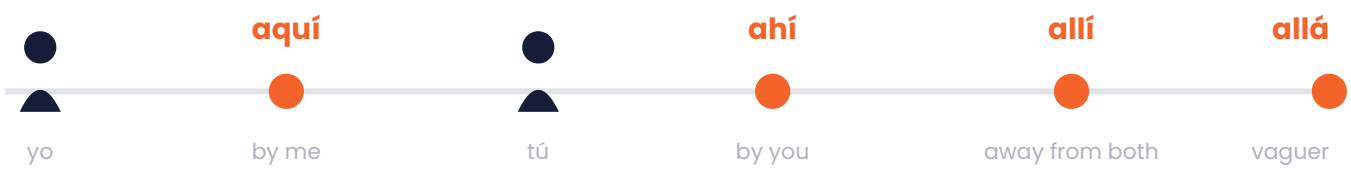


al final de
at the end of



en medio de
in the middle of

2. aquí · ahí · allí · allá English has two words for this; Spanish has four, and they measure distance from the speaker



They line up with **este · ese · aquel**: *este libro, aquí · ese libro, ahí · aquel libro, allí*. Learn them as pairs and you get both sets for the price of one.

3. They nearly all need de and the two that don't are the ones you will get wrong

encima **de** · debajo **de** · dentro **de** · fuera **de**
delante **de** · detrás **de** · al lado **de**
cerca **de** · lejos **de** · enfrente **de** · alrededor **de**
and *de + el* contracts: al lado **del** banco, lejos **del** centro

entre la mesa y la silla — no *de*, and it takes *y*
sobre la mesa — no *de* · same as *encima de*
junto **a** la ventana — this one takes *a*, not *de*
en la mesa — the everyday catch-all

The *de* only appears when something follows. *El banco está **cerca**.* — nothing after it, so no *de*. *El banco está **cerca de** mi casa.* — a noun follows, so the *de* comes back. Same for *dentro*, *delante*, *detrás*, *encima*.